



HTML CHEAT SHEET

EVERY TAG • SEMANTIC ELEMENTS • TEXT FORMATTING • MEDIA

Document Structure

Semantic Tags

Headings H1-H6

Text Formatting

Lists

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Tables

Forms

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Embedded Content

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Document Structure Tags

The root tags that define every HTML page.

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<!DOCTYPE>	Declares the document type & HTML version	<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>	Root element wrapping the whole page	<html lang="en">...</html>
<head>	Container for meta-information (not visible)	<head>...</head>
<title>	Sets the browser tab / page title	<title>My Page</title>
<meta>	Metadata: charset, viewport, description	<meta charset="UTF-8">
<link>	Links external resources (CSS, favicon)	<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
<style>	Embeds internal CSS	<style>body{margin:0}</style>
<script>	Embeds or links JavaScript	<script src="app.js"></script>
<body>	Contains all visible page content	<body>...</body>
<base>	Sets a base URL for all relative links	<base href="https://site.com/">
<noscript>	Fallback content if JS is disabled	<noscript>Enable JS</noscript>

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Headings — H1 to H6

Six levels of section headings, H1 = most important, H6 = least important.

TAG	USAGE	EXAMPLE & OUTPUT
H1 <h1>	Main page title - use once per page	Welcome to My Site
H2 <h2>	Major section heading	About Us
H3 <h3>	Sub-section heading	Our Mission
H4 <h4>	Sub-sub-section heading	Team Values
H5 <h5>	Minor heading	Note
H6 <h6>	Smallest heading level	Footnote

Tip:

Never skip heading levels for styling — use CSS for size, and headings for document outline/SEO instead.

Give meaning to page structure — improves SEO & accessibility.

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<header>	Intro / navigation area of a page or section	<header> Logo </header>
<nav>	Group of navigation links	<nav>Home</nav>
<main>	The dominant, unique content of the page	<main>...</main>
<section>	Thematic grouping of content	<section> Services </section>
<article>	Self-contained, independently distributable content	<article> Blog Post </article>
<aside>	Content tangentially related (sidebar)	<aside>Related links</aside>
<footer>	Footer for a page or section	<footer>© 2026 Company</footer>
<figure>	Groups media with its caption	<figure></figure>
<figcaption>	Caption for a <figure>	<figcaption>Fig 1: Sunset</figcaption>
<details>	Collapsible disclosure widget	<details><summary>More</summary>Info</details>
<summary>	Visible heading for <details>	<summary>Click to expand</summary>
<address>	Contact information	<address>123 Main St</address>
<time>	Machine-readable date/time	<time datetime="2026-08-05">Aug 5</time>
<mark>	Highlighted / marked text	<mark>important</mark>
<dialog>	A dialog box or modal window	<dialog open>Hello!</dialog>
<template>	Hidden content cloned via JS	<template id="t">...</template>

Style and give semantic emphasis to inline text.

Tag	Description	Example
<code></code>	Bold text (stylistic, no extra importance)	<code>Bold text</code>
<code></code>	Strong importance (bold + semantic)	<code>Warning!</code>
<code><i></code>	Italic text (alternate voice/mood)	<code><i>Italic text</i></code>
<code></code>	Emphasized text (italic + semantic stress)	<code>Really important</code>
<code><u></code>	Underlined text	<code><u>Underlined</u></code>
<code><s></code>	Text no longer accurate (strikethrough)	<code><s>\$50</s> now \$30</code>
<code></code>	Deleted / removed text (with edits)	<code>old price</code>
<code><ins></code>	Inserted / added text (with edits)	<code><ins>new price</ins></code>
<code><mark></code>	Highlighted relevant text	Search result: <code><mark>HTML</mark></code>
<code><small></code>	Fine print / side comments	<code><small>Terms apply</small></code>
<code><sub></code>	Subscript text	<code>H<sub>2</sub>O</code>
<code><sup></code>	Superscript text	<code>x<sup>2</sup></code>
<code><abbr></code>	Abbreviation with tooltip title	<code><abbr title="HyperText">HTML</abbr></code>
<code><cite></code>	Title of a creative work	<code><cite>The Odyssey</cite></code>
<code><q></code>	Short inline quotation	She said <code><q>hello</q></code>
<code><blockquote></code>	Long / block-level quotation	<code><blockquote>To be or not...</blockquote></code>
<code><code></code>	Inline code snippet	Use <code><code>let x = 5;</code></code>
<code><pre></code>	Preformatted text (preserves spacing)	<code><pre> line 1\n line 2</pre></code>
<code><kbd></code>	Keyboard input	Press <code><kbd>Ctrl+C</kbd></code>
<code><samp></code>	Sample program output	<code><samp>404 Not Found</samp></code>
<code><var></code>	Variable in math/code	<code><var>x</var> = 10</code>
<code>
</code>	Line break	Line1 Line2
<code><hr></code>	Horizontal thematic break	<code><hr></code>
<code><wbr></code>	Optional line-break opportunity	super califragilistic
<code></code>	Generic inline container	<code>Text</code>

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 Lists

Ordered, unordered and description lists.

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
	Unordered (bulleted) list	Tea
	Ordered (numbered) list	Step 1
	A list item	Item
<dl>	Description list	<dl><dt>HTML</dt><dd>Markup</dd></dl>
<dt>	Term in a description list	<dt>CSS</dt>
<dd>	Description of the term	<dd>Stylesheet language</dd>

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 Links & Images

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<a>	Hyperlink to another page/resource	Visit
	Embeds an image	
<picture>	Multiple image sources (responsive)	<picture><source srcset="a.webp"></picture>
<map>	Client-side image map	<map name="m"><area ...></map>
<area>	Clickable region inside a map	<area shape="rect" coords="0,0,50,50">

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 Table Tags

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<table>	Defines a table	<table>...</table>
<caption>	Title of the table	<caption>Sales Data</caption>
<thead>	Groups header content	<thead><tr><th>Name</th></tr></thead>
<tbody>	Groups body content	<tbody><tr><td>Amit</td></tr></tbody>
<tfoot>	Groups footer content	<tfoot><tr><td>Total</td></tr></tfoot>
<tr>	A table row	<tr><td>Data</td></tr>
<th>	A header cell (bold, centered)	<th>Column</th>
<td>	A standard data cell	<td>Value</td>
<colgroup>	Group of columns for styling	<colgroup><col span="2"></colgroup>
<col>	Column-level styling	<col style="background:#eee">

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Forms & Input Tags

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<form>	Container for interactive controls	<form action="/submit" method="post">...</form>
<input>	Single-line input (text, email, date, etc.)	<input type="text" placeholder="Name">
<label>	Caption for a form control	<label for="e">Email</label>
<textarea>	Multi-line text input	<textarea rows="4"></textarea>
<select>	Dropdown list	<select><option>A</option></select>
<option>	An item in a select/datalist	<option value="1">One</option>
<optgroup>	Groups related options	<optgroup label="Fruits">...</optgroup>
<button>	Clickable button	<button type="submit">Send</button>
<fieldset>	Groups related form controls	<fieldset><legend>Info</legend></fieldset>
<legend>	Caption for a fieldset	<legend>Personal</legend>
<datalist>	Predefined autocomplete options	<datalist id="d"><option value="A"></datalist>
<output>	Result of a calculation	<output>42</output>
<progress>	Progress of a task	<progress value="70" max="100"></progress>
<meter>	Scalar measurement within a range	<meter value="0.6"></meter>

Common input types: text, email, password, number, date, time, checkbox, radio, file, range, color, tel, url, search, hidden, submit, reset.

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Audio, Video & Embedded Content

TAG	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
<audio>	Embeds sound / music content	<audio controls> <source src="song.mp3" type="audio/mpeg"> </audio>
<video>	Embeds video content	<video controls width="300"> <source src="clip.mp4" type="video/mp4"> </video>
<source>	Media source for audio/video/picture	<source src="a.ogg" type="audio/ogg">
<track>	Subtitles / captions for media	<track kind="subtitles" src="en.vtt" srclang="en">
<iframe>	Embeds another HTML page inline	<iframe src="page.html"></iframe>
<embed>	Embeds external content/plugin	<embed src="file.pdf">
<object>	Embeds external resource/object	<object data="file.pdf"></object>
<canvas>	Draw graphics via JavaScript	<canvas id="c" width="200" height="100"></canvas>
<svg>	Scalable vector graphics	<svg><circle cx="50" cy="50" r="40"/></svg>

Attributes to remember: **controls**, **autoplay**, **loop**, **muted**, **poster** (video), **preload** work on <audio>/<video>.

Attribute	Description	Example
id	Unique identifier	<div id="header">
class	CSS class name(s)	<p class="intro bold">
style	Inline CSS styling	<p style="color:red">
title	Tooltip text on hover	<abbr title="World Health Org">
data-*	Custom data attributes	<li data-user-id="42">
hidden	Hides the element	<div hidden>
contenteditable	Makes element editable	<div contenteditable="true">
draggable	Allows drag-and-drop	
tabindex	Keyboard tab order	<div tabindex="0">
lang	Language of the content	<p lang="fr">